is only to see the Proteas do better, and of course I would also like to be playing better, but, as we speak, I haven't had the best of seasons with the bat.

As always in sport, confidence is a massive factor, and at the moment I feel I still need to convince the Proteas selectors that I can make a positive contribution to the team. Over the past year I've really begun to realise how crucial their backing is for your confidence. As I've said, I'm comfortable with the fact that my Test career is all but over, but I still believe I have what it takes to be a game-winning batsman for South Africa in limited-overs cricket. I just wish I knew where I stand – I mean, you get left out once or twice for no reason, okay, it shakes you up a bit, but the way that I've been in and out of the side over the past year has not exactly been great for my confidence. Let me put you in the picture …

After coming out of rehab and going straight to Australia at the beginning of 2009, I started off very tentatively, going out for a duck in the first T20 game, then getting only six runs in the second. The Aussies – looking to get back at us after our Test team had just famously beaten them – comfortably took the series 2-0.

After that, though, I started to get back into the swing of international cricket, and during the five-match ODI series I scored a low of seven and a high of 64 to average 30 on the nose and help the Proteas to a convincing 4-1 series win. It got better in the return series here in South Africa a few months later, when I averaged 50, including 110 off 116 balls in the series-clinching fourth ODI in PE, and then 82 in the final dead rubber at the Wanderers.

After that series we headed over to the UK for the 2009 T20 World Cup, where I put on a fairly good show, averaging 19 – the fifth-highest in the team behind Jacques Kallis, who had a great tournament, averaging a shade less than 60. I was in good form going into the semi-final, having scored 30 against the Poms and 55 against the West Indies. Unfortunately, my game went a little pear-shaped thereafter, with a five against India and another five against Pakistan in the finals.

Shahid Afridi got me with a beaut in that game – a slider on off-stump that had me playing for the leg-break … goodbye off-stump.

Our next series was, of course, the ICC Champions Trophy in South Africa in September/October 2009. Once again we bombed on home turf, failing to get past the group stage. I only played one game – the final group